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DEPARTMENT OF HUMANITIES & SOCIAL SCIENCES

END-TERM EXAMINATION Date: 16/05/2025

Course: B. Tech, Semester II	Section: G
Subject: Communication Skills	Subject Code: HUM24106
Time: 2 hours	Maximum Marks: 40
Note: All questions are compulsory.	

I. Read the passage below and answer the questions that follow: (20 marks)

In today's rapidly evolving corporate landscape, effective leadership and strategic decision-making play pivotal roles in determining an organization's success. Leadership, in its most comprehensive sense, extends beyond mere management and delves into the intricacies of vision-building, motivation, and adaptability. The contemporary business world, shaped by globalization and technological advancements, demands that leaders cultivate a dynamic approach to problem-solving while fostering an environment that encourages innovation.

One of the fundamental qualities of a successful leader is emotional intelligence. Daniel Goleman, a leading psychologist, emphasizes that emotional intelligence comprises five core elements: self-awareness, self-regulation, motivation, empathy, and social skills. A leader with high emotional intelligence can navigate organizational complexities with greater ease, ensuring that employees remain engaged and productive. Research has consistently shown that companies led by emotionally intelligent executives tend to have lower employee turnover rates and higher overall performance.

Moreover, strategic decision-making has become increasingly complex due to the sheer volume of data available in the digital age. Managers must employ analytical tools such as SWOT analysis, Porter's Five Forces, and data-driven decision-making frameworks to gain actionable insights. While traditional decision-making models were often based on intuition and experience, modern business environments require a data-centric approach to minimize risks and maximize efficiency. However, over-reliance on data without human judgment can also be detrimental, as it may overlook intangible factors such as company culture, ethical considerations, and stakeholder expectations.

An essential facet of effective leadership is the ability to foster a positive organizational culture. A company's culture—defined by its values, work environment, and internal communication—greatly impacts its long-term sustainability. Studies indicate that businesses that promote inclusivity, diversity, and employee well-being outperform their competitors. Leaders who actively invest in employee development and recognize achievements create a workplace atmosphere that enhances job satisfaction and, consequently, productivity.

Another crucial leadership skill is crisis management. In an unpredictable business world, crises—ranging from financial downturns to public relations disasters—are inevitable. Resilient leaders must possess the ability to make quick yet informed decisions under pressure. The COVID-19 pandemic served

as a critical test for business leaders worldwide, forcing them to adapt to remote work structures, disrupted supply chains, and shifting consumer behaviors. Those who demonstrated agility and proactive problem-solving not only safeguarded their organizations but also identified new growth opportunities amid the crisis.

Ethical leadership is another indispensable element in contemporary business administration. Corporate scandals, such as those involving Enron and Volkswagen, have underscored the consequences of unethical decision-making. Consumers and investors alike have become more vigilant about corporate social responsibility (CSR), compelling businesses to adopt transparent governance practices. Leaders who prioritize ethics, sustainability, and social responsibility build long-term trust, which ultimately translates into brand loyalty and financial stability.

Furthermore, globalization has transformed the role of business leaders, necessitating a global mindset. Cross-cultural competence has become a critical skill as multinational companies operate in diverse markets with varying economic, legal and cultural frameworks. Leaders must be adept at navigating these differences to ensure effective collaboration across international teams. Mismanagement of cultural diversity can lead to misunderstandings, inefficiencies and even financial losses. Therefore, the training programs that emphasize intercultural communication and global market awareness have become increasingly prevalent in leadership development.

Finally, the future of leadership will be shaped by technological innovation. Artificial intelligence, automation and digital transformation are redefining traditional business models. Forward-thinking leaders are those who embrace change, invest in technological advancements and continuously upskill their workforce to remain competitive. While some fear that automation may replace jobs, visionary leaders recognize that technology can augment human potential rather than diminish it. The organizations that successfully integrate technology with human ingenuity will lead the next wave of business evolution.

In conclusion, leadership in the modern business environment is a multifaceted discipline that extends beyond mere authority. Successful leaders must possess a combination of emotional intelligence, strategic decision-making skills, ethical responsibility, crisis management abilities and a global perspective. As businesses continue to evolve in an increasingly complex and digitalized world, the leaders who adapt, inspire and innovate will shape the future of the corporate sphere.

1. According to the passage why is emotional intelligence important for effective leadership?
2. How does data-driven decision-making both benefit and challenge modern leaders?
3. Discuss the role of organizational culture in determining a company's long-term success.
4. Imagine you are the CEO of a multinational company. What strategies would you implement to navigate cultural differences in global business operations?
5. Do you think ethical leadership is more critical today than it was in the past? Justify your answer with examples.

II. **Write a summary of the book you had chosen for presentation. Write the name and author of the book. (approximately 300 words) 8 marks**

III. **Discuss the role of interpersonal skills in the quality of life. (approx.100 words) 6 marks**

IV. **Discuss the role of listening in communication. What hinders effective listening? 6 marks**